

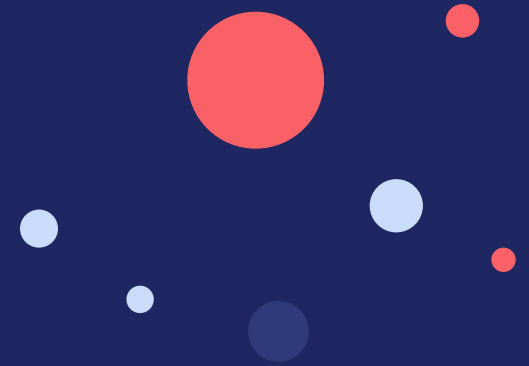
TRUSTMRR · SESSION 3 DATASET

The Power Law of Indie SaaS

What 1,000 founder-run startups reveal about where the money — and the growth — really concentrates

A data story · Abhishek Borade

1,000 rows · frozen 30 Jul 2026



THE BIG PICTURE

1,000 Companies. One Very Uneven Market.

1,000

Founder-run startups
tracked on TrustMRR

\$13.47M

Combined monthly
recurring revenue

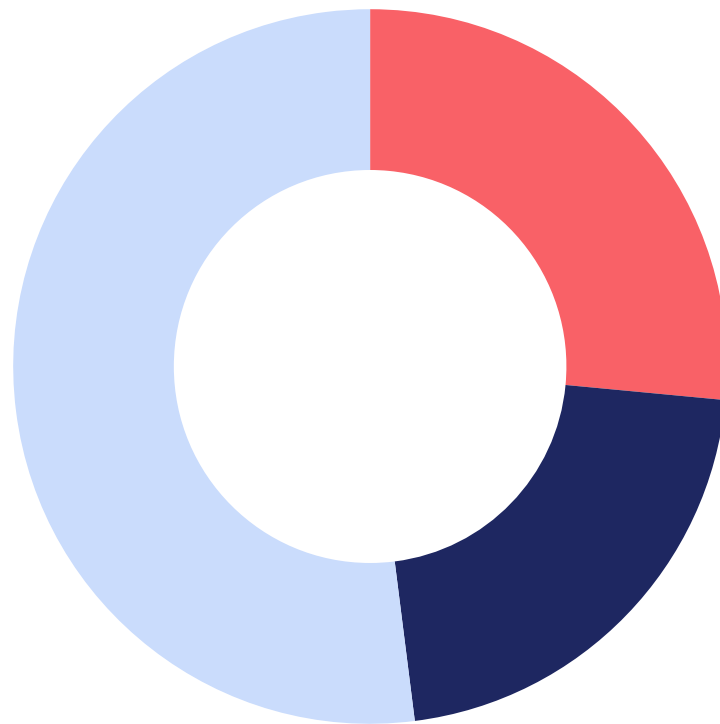
\$282

The median company's
monthly recurring revenue

The average company's MRR is **\$13,472** — roughly **48x** the median. When the mean dwarfs the median this badly, a small number of outliers are doing almost all the work. The rest of this deck is about who they are.

CONCENTRATION

Ten Companies Control Nearly Half the Market

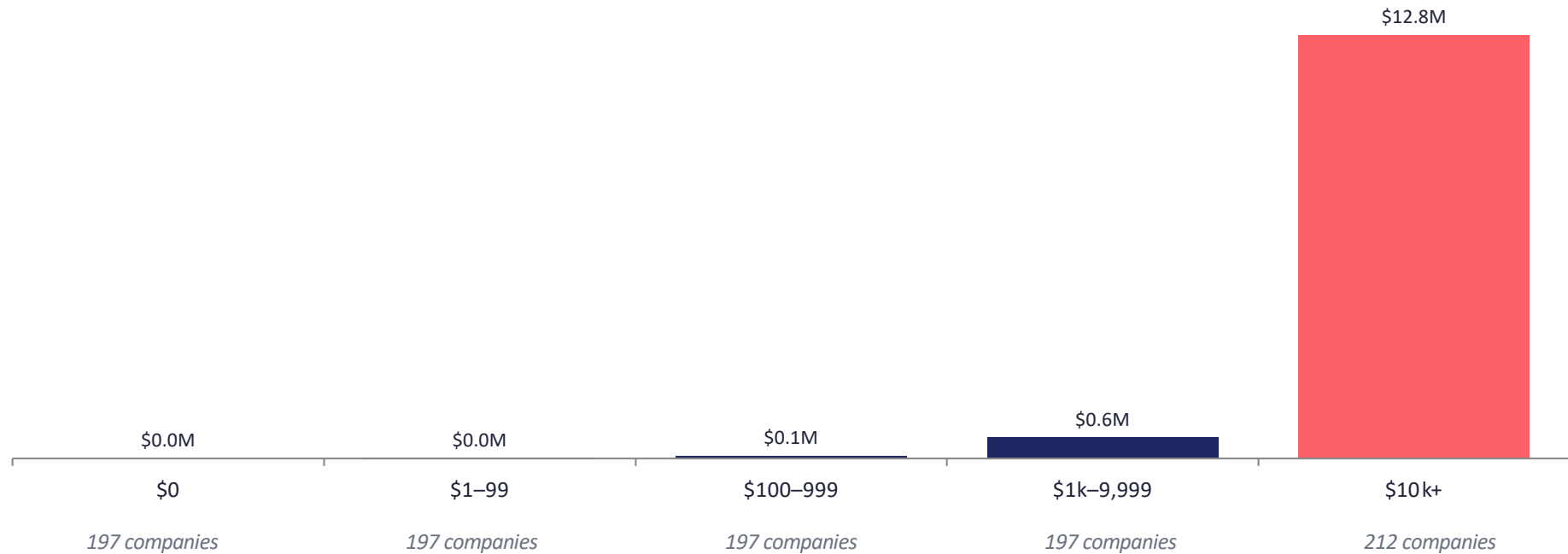


Stan (#1)	26.5%
Rest of top 10	21.5%
Everyone else — 990 companies	52.0%

\$3.57M in monthly revenue from a single company — Stan — exceeds the combined MRR of the bottom 900 companies in the dataset (\$2.45M).

CONCENTRATION, PART TWO

Same Number of Companies, Wildly Different Payoffs

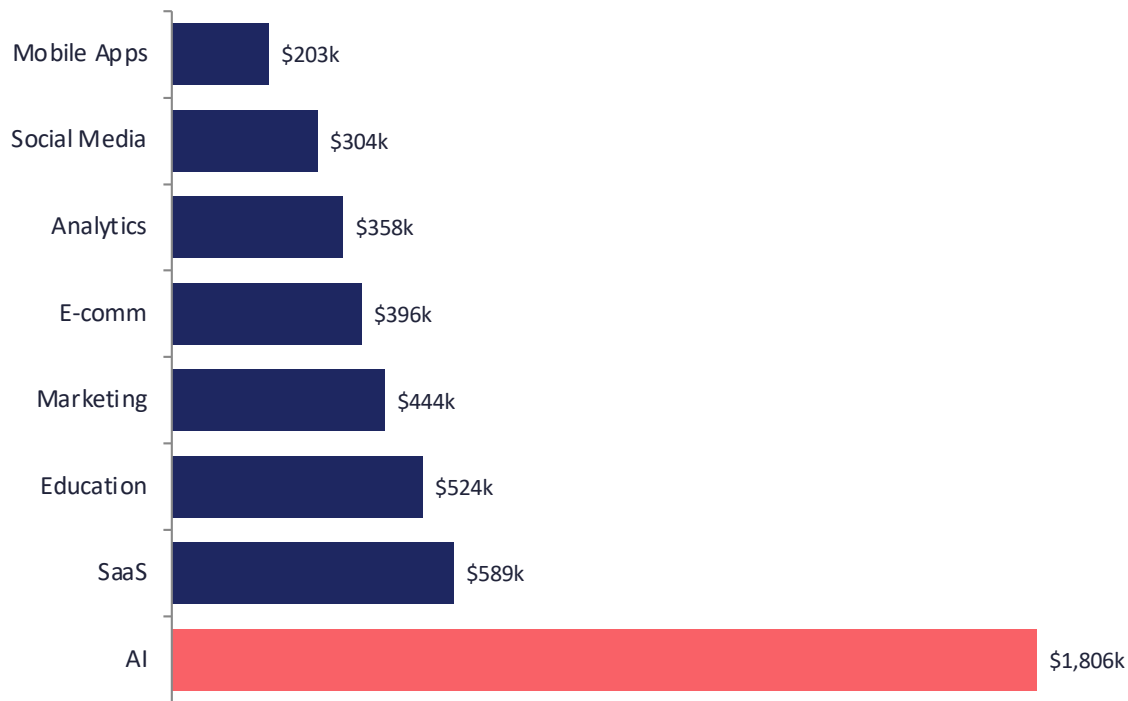


The top band (**\$10k+ MRR**) is only **21% of companies** — but it holds **95% of all revenue** in the dataset. Every band below it has almost the same headcount, and almost none of the money.

TrustMRR · 1,000-startup dataset · frozen 30 Jul 2026

WHERE FOUNDERS ARE BUILDING

AI Is Both the Most Crowded Category — and the Best Monetized



197

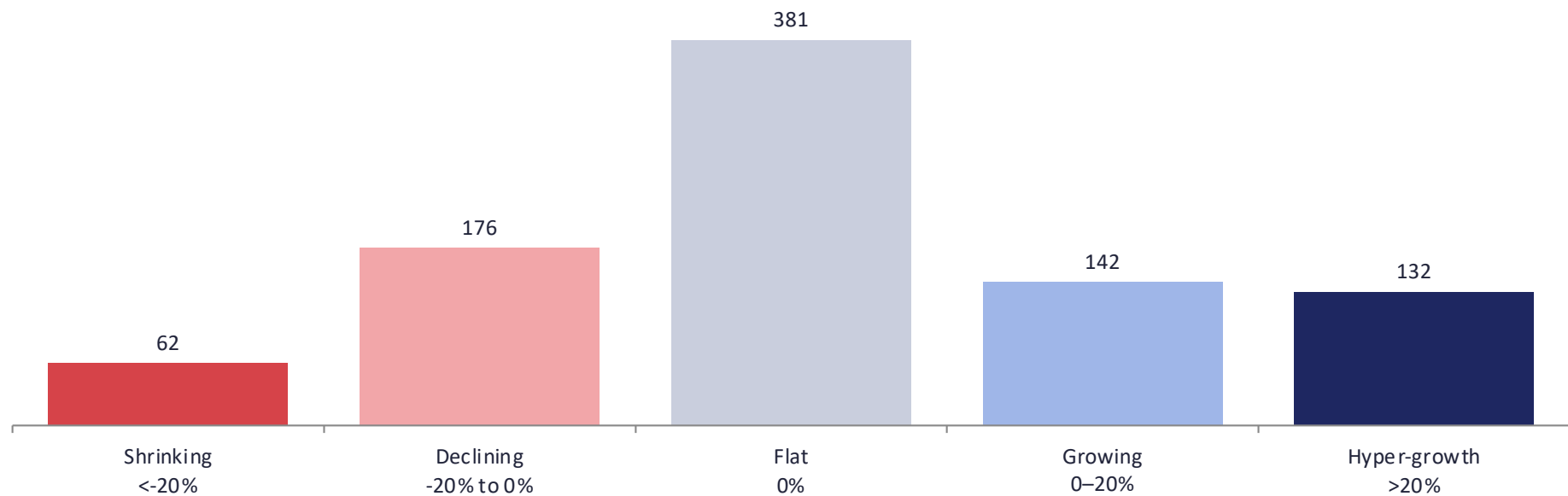
companies are building in AI — 27% of every startup with a labeled category, more than any other single vertical

\$446 vs \$277

Median MRR for an AI startup, versus the median for every other category. AI companies out-earn the field even before counting the giants.

MOMENTUM

Most Startups Are Standing Still

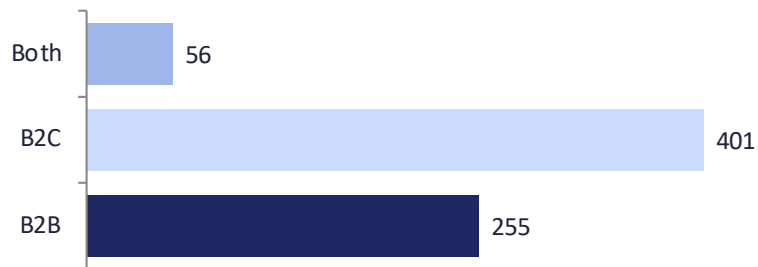


Of the 893 companies reporting 30-day MRR growth, **43% were exactly flat** last month. Only **15% hit hyper-growth** (>20% MoM), and 7% were in outright decline of more than 20%. Growth, like revenue, is concentrated in a minority.

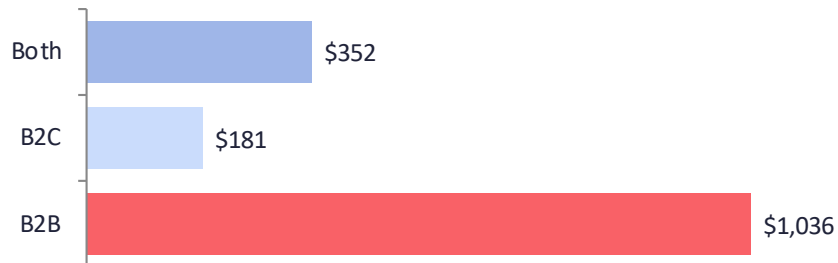
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B2B Startups Are Fewer — and Charge For It

Share of companies



Median monthly MRR



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5.7x

B2B's median MRR advantage over B2C

B2C startups outnumber B2B ones by roughly 3-to-2 (401 vs 255) — but the typical B2B company still pulls in \$1,036 a month against \$181 for the typical B2C app. Fewer customers, much higher willingness to pay.

GEOGRAPHY

The US Dominates — But Not Proportionally



34% → 56%

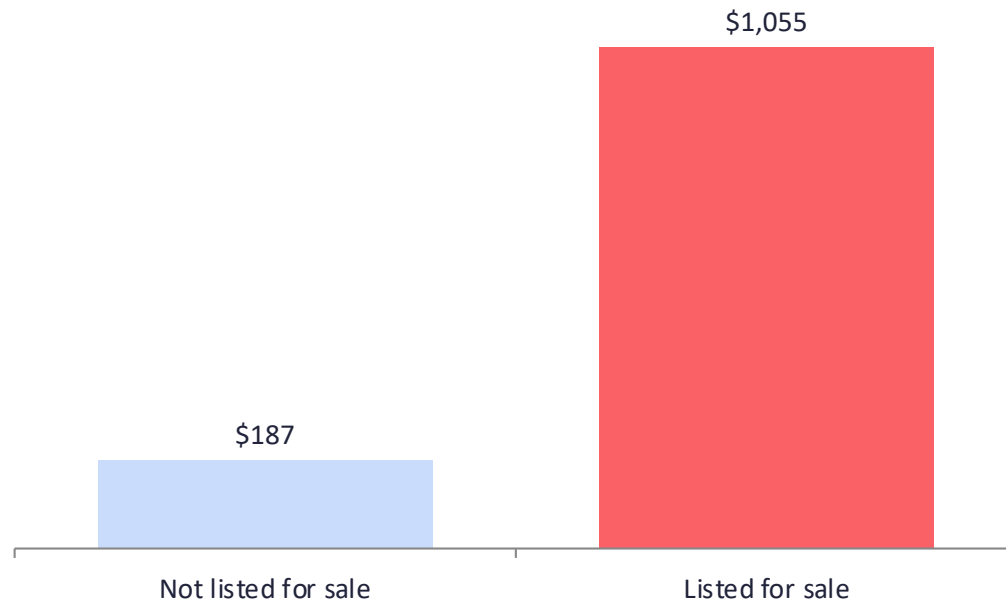
The US holds 34% of companies with a listed country, but captures 56% of all MRR

#2

France is the surprise runner-up: just 79 companies, but the second-largest MRR pool of any country (\$894k)

Companies Listed for Sale Are the Healthier Half

Median monthly MRR



5.6x

Startups listed for sale carry 5.6x the median MRR of the rest of the dataset — sellers list their winners, not their duds.

2.3x

Typical asking price for a listed company, expressed as a multiple of annual revenue — with asking price and MRR strongly correlated ($r \approx 0.81$).

TAKEAWAYS

Indie SaaS Runs on a Power Law

1

Revenue is extremely concentrated

The top 21% of companies hold 95% of all MRR; one company (Stan) outweighs the bottom 900 combined.

2

AI leads on both fronts

It's the most crowded category and out-earns every other vertical on a per-company basis.

3

Growth is rare, not typical

43% of companies were flat last month; only 15% hit hyper-growth.

4

B2B monetizes harder

Fewer B2B companies, but 5.7x the median MRR of B2C.

5

Geography is lopsided

The US holds 34% of companies but 56% of the revenue; France punches well above its weight.

6

The exit market skims the cream

Startups listed for sale carry 5.6x the typical MRR, pricing around 2.3x annual revenue.